

Subject: Socius Decision

Date: Thursday, May 4, 2023 at 1:58:40 PM Eastern Daylight Time

From: Socius: Sociological Research for a Dynamic World

To: Pablo Bello

04-May-2023

Dear Pablo Bello:

We write you in regards to manuscript # SRD-23-0072 entitled "Visualizing Change in Sociological Theory" that you submitted to Socius. We review each of the visualizations as an editorial team. After this review, we have decided not to publish this manuscript.

While the visualization has several strengths and this kind of figure could contribute to ongoing debates about how sociology has changed over time. The current strategy lacks adequate justification along several important dimensions. First, the selection of journals is not transparent. Why these journals and not others? The selection obviously matters when conclusions are being offered towards the discipline as a whole. More importantly, the selection of the theorists requires justification and should include some more systematic strategy. As of now, the selection of these theorists seems arbitrary and it isn't clear how an arbitrary group of theorists speaks to broader sociological patterns. A different collection would exhibit a different result. Last, the network figures aren't obviously useful here when the centrality measures describe what we would hope to see in the networks and the networks are somewhat small visually and therefore difficult to "read."

We would consider a figure that offers more justification for the journal selection and a more systematic approach to sampling theorists (e.g., top theorists cited in Sociological Theory or some such) as a new submission.

Thank you for considering Socius. We hope the outcome of this specific submission will not discourage you from the submission of future manuscripts.

Sincerely,
Ryan Light, Aaron Gullickson, and CJ Pascoe
Editors, Socius

Reviewer Comments to Author: